

Blaupunkt on staying relevant in the Indian market

Sukhesh Madaan, CEO, Blaupunkt Audio India gives us an insight into how Blaupunkt is working towards capturing the lucrative Indian audio market

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The Indian audio market is a rapidly burgeoning one and brands across the globe are scurrying around to attempt to capture this lucrative market. Blaupunkt is an iconic German audio brand that attempts to do the same with its array of audio products. We spoke to Sukhesh Madaan, CEO, Blaupunkt Audio India to gain insight into the German brand's audio journey in India, and learn about their newest product and future plans.

Q Blaupunkt Audio is still one of the relatively lesser-known audio brands in India but is exceptionally popular in the global market. Can you discuss what is being done to stand out from the crowd in India specifically?

Madaan: Blaupunkt is an Iconic German brand with over 124 years of technology development and innovation in the audio industry. It is known globally for its premium personal and home audio products. In India, the company has a rich history in the car audio market and has over the decades made a name for itself here. In India, Blaupunkt has tailor-made and fine-tuned its range to meet local desires and expectations. Richer bass, a larger number of features, more contemporary designs and a more durable build. These enhancements have been made after research and a vast amount of real-world testing. In addition to the actual

products, Blaupunkt has also taken care of the price points keeping in mind its customer bases. To satisfy all segments, Blaupunkt has ensured its price points across its range always offer better value for money.

Q TWS earphones have exploded in popularity over the past few years. However, is it paramount to be innovative in this segment to stay on top of the market. How is Blaupunkt Audio tackling innovation for TWS earbuds? Are there any segment-first features we will get to witness from Blaupunkt TWS?

Madaan: Yes, the TWS market has really come to age this year. Blaupunkt is following a multi-pronged strategy to be on top of it

- 1. Technology Evolution:** we are leading it from the front. We launched products with the latest tech i.e. with ENC & ANC functions which are the latest new trends in the market. In fact, our next launch is coming with 6 Mics to give you the utmost feel of ANC technology.
- 2. Design Innovation:** After initial confusion and hiccups in consumers' minds, there is a clear preference setting up in consumer minds to have TWS with a stick. So all our new models are coming with them. On top, the market is really maturing to try different colours and so in our latest launches like BTW100 & BTW15 etc, we are launching various exciting colour options like

Alpine Green, Sierra Blue etc.

- 3. Affordability:** As TWS tech is maturing there is a constant price correction in the market. Blaupunkt is leading it from the front while offering great quality with features and pricing. Our latest ENC TWS has been launched at a super aggressive price point of 1499/- we want the Blaupunkt range of products to reach out to a wider audience so they can use and appreciate the Technology and Quality of the products.

Q How does Blaupunkt plan to thrive in the cut-throat market competition, which is dominated by companies such as Skullcandy, Boat, JBL, and others?

Madaan: The Indian market is crowded with new brands popping up every day. Right now, the market is dominated by Skullcandy, Boat, JBL, RealMe, Oppo and a few others. But consumers are always looking out for better products that offer better value for money. Blaupunkt has noticed that just being cheap is not what consumers want. Brand value, technology, durability and a lot of flash value are what help people decide on a purchase. And this is what it delivers. As for TWS Tech, this is the standard in the consumer's mind today. People know this tech is one generation ahead and have seen its benefits and advantages. Blaupunkt was one of the pioneers of this tech and has launched a wide range of products, earbuds, speakers, etc, that incorporate it. **Q**